can use a single attribute as the primary key. DynamoDB calls this a partition key. You need an item's partition key to look up that item. Also, when updating or deleting an item, DynamoDB requires the partition key. You can also use two attributes as the primary key. In this case, one of the attributes is the partition key, and the other is called the sort key.

12.7.1 Partition key

A partition key uses a single attribute of an item to create a hash-based index. If you want to look up an item based on its partition key, you need to know the exact partition key. For example, a user table could use the user's email address as a partition key. The user could then be retrieved if you know the partition key—the email address, in this case.

12.7.2 Partition key and sort key

When you use both a partition key and a sort key, you're using two attributes of an item to create a more powerful index. To look up an item, you need to know its exact partition key, but you don't need to know the sort key. You can even have multiple items with the same partition key: they will be sorted according to their sort key.

The partition key can be queried only using exact matches (=). The sort key can be queried using `=`, `>`, `<`, `>=`, `<=`, and `BETWEEN x AND y` operators. For example, you can query the sort key of a partition key from a certain starting point. You cannot query only the sort key—you must always specify the partition key. A message table could use a partition key and sort key as its primary key; the partition key could be the user's email, and the sort key could be a timestamp. You could